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ugust 21, 2012. Eight years after announcing-

Counter-Strike: Source, the successor to the original Counter-Strike 1.6, Valve released what was going to be a monument in the history of FPS games, Counter-Strike: Global Offensive. One of the most played games on Steam, CS:GO, as the fans like calling it, recently completed 10 years of its launch. So, we decided to pay our tribute to what is very accurately labelled as: Your favourite first-person shooter's favourite first-person shooter.

HUMBLE BEGINNINGS

Counter-Strike: Global Offensive was not an immensely popular game right after its launch. When CS:GO launched, the entire CS community was polarised. There were two camps, one that played the older, CS:S and 1.6 and the other who loved the new kid on the block. For about two years, a civil war raged within the Counter-Strike community.

It wasn't the people's fault too. At the time of its launch, CS:GO felt raw. The mechanics weren't polished and the gameplay and models inside the game felt... plasticky. Couple that with the human psyche that tends to resent drastic changes to the things that they love, and you have a recipe for disaster.



SOURCE: VALVE

However, Valve was quick to make changes and make efforts (something that we do not see these days), to improve the CS:GO experience. As time passed and patches were released, and more and more tournament organisers started taking up CS:GO for international events, the game started gaining traction.

In its early years, CS:GO saw people slowly shifting over. And, as it would be with any game like CS:GO,



SOURCE: STEAM CHARTS

it soon broke into the top spots of the popularity charts. As more and more people started playing the game, the stronger the community became. There were streams playing CS:GO live for hours at end, and tournaments with million-dollar prize pools. CS:GO had gone from being the David of the FPS world, to the Goliath that everyone looked up to with increased fondness.

OF CASES AND OPERATIONS

As the popularity of CS:GO grew, Valve saw an enticing business opportunity. Just a year after CS:GO's launch, the developers announced that the game would be getting SKINS as a part of the Arms Deal Update. These skins could be obtained via two methods – loot boxes and in-game drops. Not only this, if you had 10 skins of the same

quality, you could trade them up to a single item from the higher quality tier. The best thing about these skins were, they were instantly tradable, at least at the time of launch.

CS:GO was headed in the right direction. However, the addition of skins gave it a movement ability boost of a 100, and the game rocketed towards being immensely popular. As we told you earlier, streamers and creators took on CS:GO to stream and create content out of. Right? Well, the introduction of skins can be considered to be a great addition that accelerated that change.



SOURCE: VALVE

Not only the creators, the ones who wanted to make the most out of their money that they had invested in the game, also got onto the skins train. Soon there were countless markets for trading skins for loot box keys, and the worst of all, skins gambling sites. There were, and still there are people whose only source of income is skins trading. Even the pro players, whom we will talk about later in the article, indulged in skins, and to this day make it a point to bring their